

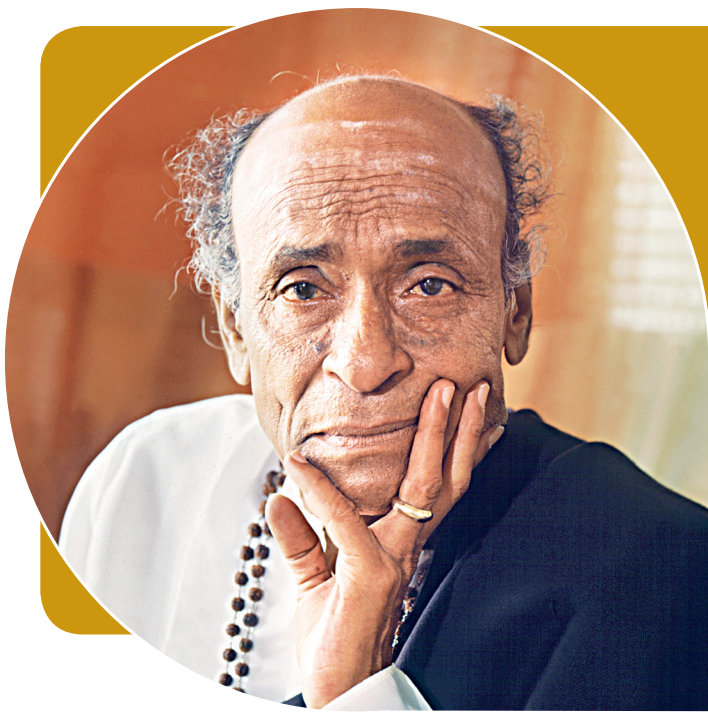
Ustad Bismillah Khan

(1916-2006)

Taking a humble reed instrument from the temples and ghats of Varanasi to the Red Fort on the day of our Independence in 1947, he also gave freedom to the shehnai to soar and become a mainstream classical concert instrument. Before him, no could have imagined the hard-textured, shrill timbre of this Indian oboe essaying the complex patterns of raga music. The deceptive ease with which he did it sat naturally with his simple Banarasi charm.



AFP



Pt Mallikarjun Mansur

(1910-1992)

A man of the soil, Mansurji brought rare ragas and bandishes to the concert stage with his simple yet highly evocative presentation. An inborn flair for the melodic elaboration and interpretation patented by his Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana, and his deliciously smoky voice with that latent Carnatic trace intact, breathed subtle fire into compositions.

BCCL